SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

EXPLORING THE FACTORS INFLUENCING ACADEMIC SUCCESS OF COLLEGE STUDENTS IN SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

A Thesis Presented To

The Faculty of

College of Tourism and Hospitality Management

In Partial Requirements for the Degree

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE AND HOSPITALITY MANAGEMENT

By

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2025

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Education is critical because it helps students grow and learn, and it also helps the country develop. How well students do in school shows how good their education is. Many factors can affect students' grades, including learning skills, family background, friends, teachers, and school facilities Karl Briones et al. (2021): Wang et al., (2025). Problems like not having enough food or a safe home, feeling stressed, or money troubles can make learning harder. Recent studies show that stress, financial issues, and not enough support from schools are among the main reasons students struggle in their studies (World Bank, 2022; CHED reports, 2023).

The COVID-19 pandemic caused significant changes in education all over the world and made learning harder for many students. (Abdullah et al., 2022) found that college students' grades declined due to stress, emotional struggles, and differences in support from teachers and parents. This result shows that having strong support from adults is very important. (Rakesh et al., 2024) also found that a student's family income affects learning, including language and thinking skills, as well as access to school materials. (Javornik & Klemenčič Mirazchiyski, 2023) stated that good schools and teachers—those who teach well, lead well, and create a positive school environment—are essential for student success.

The behavior and health of students really affect how well they do in school. For instance, (Armand et al., 2021) found that not getting enough sleep makes students participate less in class and lowers their grades. After the pandemic, new things became essential for learning, such as motivation, the learning environment, mental health, and computer skills

(Koçak et al., 2021; Vestfal & Seduikyte, 2024). Even with many changes in education, differences in achievement between rich and poor students still exist, underscoring the need for policies to make learning fair for everyone (Chmielewski, 2023). Al Husaini and Shukor (2022) also found that students who start school with low grades or do not get enough family support are more likely to struggle in their studies.

In the Philippines, the COVID-19 pandemic affected people's daily lives and made it harder for students to adapt, which disrupted the entire education system. For example, Physical Education students had lower grades because they did not have enough learning devices, had poor internet connections, faced financial difficulties, and struggled with mental health, which also made them less motivated and less active in class (Aragon et al., 2022). The article "The Philippine Education Crisis: Grade Inflation, Competency Gaps, and PISA 2022 Insights" (TeacherPH, 2024) explains that students' actual achievement in the Philippines is unclear because of grade inflation and gaps in skills, as shown by the country's poor PISA 2022 results. The article suggested using authentic assessments, better teacher training, and educational reforms to ensure that grades truly reflect what students have learned. Socioeconomic inequalities and limited access to technology make these learning gaps even bigger, preventing many students from reaching global standards. Research also shows that support helps students succeed. (Corpuz et al., 2022) found that students do better when parents are involved, teachers are effective, and peers interact positively. Without this support, students are more likely to struggle. Lier et al. (2024) also found that students' grades improve when their parents have higher education, good jobs, and steady income. Data from the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) and the Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA) show ongoing problems, including low graduation and retention rates, caused mainly by financial constraints, mental health

challenges, and unequal access to learning resources.

The study on the factors affecting academic performance of college students situates student achievement as a combination of personal, social, and institutional factors that may hinder or enhance academic success. In this study, academic success is operationalized using academic performance as its primary indicator and how they relate. This study might help the tourism and hospitality industry better prepare students academically and personally.

The goal of this research is to find out and study the factors that affect how well college students at Saint Michael College of Caraga do in school (S.Y. 2025-2026). This study can help teachers, students, and other stakeholders. The results can help school administrators to understand what the students need and what challenges they face. This can help improve the curriculum, make teaching better, and find better ways to run the school. The study can also help everyone understand the bigger factors that affect student performance, supporting the development of hardworking and determined graduates who are ready to succeed in the fast-paced hospitality and tourism industry.

1.2 Theoretical Framework

The concept of "success" is associated with favourable results obtained from an action that has the effect of increasing an individual's satisfaction with his or her own performance. "Success" is an attribute of actions designed to produce satisfaction in the context of achieving predetermined goals. Success is associated with: success, achievement, performance obtained by a person or a group and recognized as such by the collectivity (Popescu, 1998). Based on these definitional projections, academic success is associated with students' academic achievement and performance. The variables, “academic success" and "academic performance" can be operationalized as follows: accomplishment of academic tasks under well-established conditions, achievement of goals, superior evaluations of academic results, academic social recognition, and academic rewards. Academic success can be explained from several perspectives: psychological, social, cultural and economic.

Academic achievement refers to what students learn after participating in structured learning experiences. It is the degree to which students meet the objectives set in a course, which could be set by teachers, school administrators, or the students themselves. Success depends on students taking responsibility for their own learning, setting SMART goals, and developing self-discipline. Feedback, like grades and satisfaction, helps understand learning experiences but may not always reflect what students have truly learned (Sockalingam, 2012).

This study is also anchored on Walberg's (1981) Theory of Educational Efficiency, which looks at what affects learning in schools. Walberg and other researchers studied over 3,000 investigations and found 28 categories of factors that influence learning. Eight of these are social and emotional factors: classroom management, parental support, student-teacher relationships, social behavior, motivation, emotional traits, peer groups, school culture, and classroom

environment (Greenberg et al., 2003). Other factors, like government policies, school rules, or curriculum, were less influential.

Research on resilience also supports these ideas. Even children in difficult situations can succeed if they have personal skills, good study habits, social skills, and no serious behavioral problems (Gutman, Sameroff & Eccles, 2002). Large reviews of classroom research confirm that Walberg's model of educational productivity is accurate. According to this model, classroom learning depends on four main components: student ability, motivation, quality of teaching, and time spent learning. Other supporting factors, like the home environment, classroom setting, peer influence, and media exposure, also help. All these factors work together, and if one is weak, others can sometimes compensate, but learning will be slower if key factors are missing (Haertel, Walberg & Weinstein, 1983).

Together, these justify the investigation of attendance, study habits, teacher engagement, and socioeconomic background as interconnected determinants of academic success among college students. Walberg's Theory of Educational Efficiency provides a structural lens for how classroom, teacher, and student factors influence academic productivity. Resilience research by Gutman, Sameroff & Eccles, (2002) provides a psychological and social lens for how personal skills, study habits, and support systems mitigate barriers like low SES.

1.3 Review of Related Literature

Academic Success and Performance

The willingness of students and how well they do in school shows how prepared they are for their future and chosen careers. For instance, Cao et al., (2024) examined multiple determinants of academic success in college students using structural equation modeling and a questionnaire survey. The study found that personal factors such as self-efficiency and interest, along with environmental influences, significantly shape academic success, implying that academic success extends beyond mere grades to encompass broader individual and contextual influences. For instance, research analyzing key predictors of academic success reported that previous academic performance measures, including high school grades and GPA, significantly influence future academic outcomes in higher education, suggesting that performance metrics can effectively predict student success over time (Suleiman et al., 2024). Many things affect students' academic success, not just one. In a study conducted by Olamit et al., (2020) the factors affecting academic performance of college students were examined. The findings revealed that variables such as home, school, students, and teacher-related factors significantly influenced students' academic performance. Since academic performance is a core indicator of academic success, these findings are relevant in understanding the factors that contribute to students' overall academic success in higher education.

Home-Related Factor

The home environment is a significant factor. For instance, Mae (2024) found that parents believe sending their children to school helps them gain valuable knowledge and skills—often at a higher level than those who do not attend school. These skills enable students to secure stable jobs, earn higher incomes, and build successful lives. Therefore, education really

plays a vital role in reducing poverty. Maghanoy et al. (2025) said that parents' support is very important for students' learning. When parents provide the materials and resources their children need, students feel more confident and motivated to do well in school. However, the study also showed that even with strong parental help, grades do not always improve.

In fact, (Cuabo et al., (2024) found that attitudes and teachers' classroom management all affect school performance. The home environment was especially important for doing well in math. Additionally, Kaizirege and Biswalo, (2023) studied how home factors affect students in Tanzania. They found that some parents give their children too many chores, which leaves them tired and little time for homework. Families with less money also struggle to provide learning materials, making it harder for children to study. Other problems, such as limited learning resources at home, parents with low levels of education, long travel to school, little supervision, and family conflicts, can make it harder for students to do well in school.

School-Related Factors

The main goal of schools is to help students do well in their studies, and teachers play a big role in this. Research shows that personal habits, support systems, and access to resources all affect how well students learn. Teachers' effectiveness depends on their confidence, students' cooperation, guidance from school leaders, and motivation at work. To help students do better, schools should offer mentorship programs, improve teachers' working conditions, and provide enough teaching materials and learning tools (Mensah et al., 2024). Moreover, Njuguna (2021) found that school culture affects students' grades. A positive school culture helps students learn better and supports the country's development goals. Karimian, (2023) also said that strong relationships in universities help students and teachers see the school as effective.

Using digital learning tools can also improve grades. Mendoza and Velasco (2023) and Javed et al. (2025) found that students who used digital platforms often had higher GPAs and finished courses more successfully. Some tools, like e-books and digital libraries, helped grades the most, while Learning Management Systems (like MUELE) helped students complete courses.

Just like how Lago (2025) studied how students felt about their classrooms. Students liked interactive lessons and supportive teachers, but gave lower ratings to noisy classrooms and poor access to services. Classroom satisfaction was highest for fourth-year students. The study suggested improving comfort, emotional support, services, and teaching methods to create positive and engaging learning spaces, especially for tourism and hospitality students.

Motivation, gaining knowledge, and using technology effectively all help students learn better (Aslinda Mohd Shahril et al., 2024). Teachers should use technology in ways that make learning fun, help students build knowledge, and improve understanding. Paulines and Tantiado (2024) found that good classroom management also helps students do better. Teachers who set clear rules, model good behavior, give fair tests, and create a supportive environment encourage students to stay motivated, participate, and achieve higher grades.

Student-Related Factor

While many factors can influence academic performance, study habits remain one of the most adaptable and essential components for improving learning outcomes (Safi, 2025; Suleiman et al., 2024). Kunle (2023) examined how employment status, learning style preferences, test anxiety, and English communication skills affect students' GPAs. The study found that three factors—test anxiety, learning style preferences, and English communication skills—had a significant impact on students' academic performance.

Walker et al. (2024) explored various aspects of student motivation —such as attributional style, self-efficacy, achievement goal orientation, self-determination, and task value —in relation to academic performance. The study found that mastery avoidance goals had the highest correlation with academic outcomes, suggesting that motivation plays a vital role in student achievement, particularly in online and blended learning environments. The lack of strong predictive relationships between certain motivational factors and performance also carries significant implications for educators and policymakers, who often assume these connections to be stronger than they are. Furthermore, Moesarofah et al. (2023) examined how self-control and emotion regulation affect students' grades. They found that students who can stay calm, motivated, and disciplined are more likely to do well in school. The study suggested that creating positive and fun learning experiences helps students stay engaged.

Moreover, El-Awady et al. (2022) found that personal habits, mental health, and the environment all affect students' success. Good study habits, motivation, self-discipline, and time management help students get better grades. Stress and low self-esteem can make students perform worse. A supportive home, family help, and good classrooms also improve performance. Qian Meng and Qi Zhang (2023) found that students with high self-efficacy (self-belief) study more, earn better grades, and are less likely to drop out. Students with low confidence may avoid challenges and get lower grades. In fact, Hadi Rajabbeigi et al. (2023) found that character strengths, such as perseverance and effective learning strategies, help students perform well, while factors like age or gender are less important.

The study of Barcenas and Bibon (2022) found that students who studied very little had lower academic performance. Also, Garg (2023) said that a bit of stress can help students stay active, but too much stress hurts mental and physical health. Problems such as financial issues,

poor time management, and average grades can cause anxiety, distract students, and lower their performance. Additionally, a supportive school environment, good study habits, motivated students, effective teaching, and enough resources are very important for success (Leomar D. Garcia, 2025; Vijayamalar et al., 2024).

To conclude, doing well in school depends not just on intelligence but also on effort and hard work. Schools should give students high-quality learning materials and resources to help them succeed (Dalauta, Ferenal, & Comon, 2024). Perhaps, Liljana Ramasaco (2024) found that family support, living in school dorms, and personal resilience are important for success. Students who got both emotional and financial support from parents did better. Resilient students were more likely to succeed, while study hours, time management, stress, and social media use did not seem to affect grades much.

Teacher-Related Factor

In the research paper entitled "Student Satisfaction in Hospitality and Tourism Programs: The Interplay of Lecturer Competency and Institutional Reputation," by M. S. A. Latip et al. (2025), it was concluded that a teacher's skill significantly impacts student satisfaction in hospitality and tourism programs. Besides, the institution's credibility is another important factor: it influences how teachers' skills affect students' satisfaction with their programs. Excellent teaching alongside a respected institution creates a canopy of student satisfaction in hospitality and tourism studies. Additionally, the study by Zhang et al. (2022) found that tourism students' learning gains significantly enhanced their employability, particularly in knowledge acquisition, innovation, teamwork, ethics, and learning skills. High-quality teaching, effective curriculum design, and competent instructors directly improved these learning gains.

Teacher factors influence academic performance; hence, the better the teaching and learning approaches, the better the students' academic performance (Mat Nawi et al., 2023). To support this, Hermoso and Brobo (2023) examined how teaching competencies influence educators' overall performance and how these competencies can serve as a foundation for designing professional development programs. The researchers emphasized that teachers with higher levels of pedagogical, personal, and social competencies tend to demonstrate stronger classroom performance and improved student learning outcomes. Their findings suggested that continuous training and evaluation are essential in enhancing teachers' instructional effectiveness. The study also proposed the creation of a professional development framework tailored to the identified competency gaps, aiming to sustain educational quality and teacher growth.

According to the study by Canuto et al. (2024), the lack of correlation between teaching competencies and academic achievement suggests that, despite possessing the necessary skills and knowledge, teachers may struggle to translate their competencies into tangible improvements in students' academic performance. It is possible for teachers to build a learning environment that is more inclusive and engaging by addressing the diversity of learners. Moreover, Lindero and Sario (2024) examined the relationship between teachers' competence and students' 21st-century learning skills in the Montevista District, Division of Davao de Oro, during the 2023–2024 academic year. It has been said that teachers' competence across four dimensions—classroom management, teaching effectiveness, assessment practices, and technology use—alongside students' skills in critical thinking, problem solving, creativity, communication, and collaboration. The results revealed a significant correlation between teacher competence and students' critical thinking, problem-solving, and creative thinking skills,

but no significant relationship with communication and collaboration. Overall, the study concluded that teacher competence did not significantly predict students' 21st-century learning skills, with technology use identified as the weakest area among teachers.

The study by Cebelleros and Buenaventura (2024) found that the academic climate had the strongest influence on student engagement and was the most impactful aspect of the learning environment. The relationships among the learning environment, teacher communication behavior, and student engagement were all statistically significant, showing moderate to strong positive correlations. It is recommended that teachers take an active role in fostering student engagement by creating meaningful learning activities, participating in training on effective classroom preparation, and providing students with opportunities to share suggestions for improving the school environment to make it more conducive to learning.

Teachers should create an environment that empowers all students to reach their potential by continually improving their methods through professional development and inclusive teaching practices (Madrid & Oco, 2025). The article "Factors Affecting Students' Retention in Hospitality Management Program at Bestlink College of the Philippines A.Y. 2021–2022" by Herbert Lintao & Lilyjoy Joy Lintao examines the factors that influence students' retention in the Hospitality Management program. Using a descriptive survey method with 50 student respondents, the authors find that social integration (such as faculty and peer relationships), academic integration (grades, intellectual development), and engaging teaching methods are significant factors in student retention. They recommend that colleges enhance teacher-student interaction, motivate students, and design creative instructional strategies to boost retention.

Related Studies

The "Factors Affecting Students' Academic Performance: In the Case of the Accounting Study of the National University of Mongolia," by Davaatseren et al., (2024)), found that 18% of the variation in student performance was explained by factors such as students' attitude, family, institutional environment, career choice, and peers. Among these, students' attitude contributed the most, with a 41% positive effect, followed by friends' characteristics (18%), institutional environment (9%), and career choice (2%). In comparison, family support showed a 13% negative effect that was less significant. Additionally, teacher performance, instructional media, and parental control each had a significant positive influence—individually and collectively—on students' academic performance, particularly in economics (Selviana et al., 2023).

In fact, Brew, (2021) aimed at how various student needs influence academic performance. It found that truancy has a significant negative impact, sometimes leading to school dropout. Additionally, factors such as parental education and income, the availability and accessibility of textbooks, libraries, practical laboratories, meal provisions, and teacher support were shown to significantly affect students' academic outcomes. Students who are academically above average and have greater exposure to these supportive factors tend to perform better than those with limited access to them.

In Mansehra City (Pakistan), Gul et al., (2024) investigate the various factors influencing the academic performance of BS students, highlighting social, economic, parental, family, and human resource-related factors as significant determinants of students' GPAs. Students from higher social and economic backgrounds, with supportive parents and access to basic facilities, tend to perform better academically. While factors such as peer influence, gender, culture, and

institutional background were found to be less significant, parental motivation, teacher behavior, and available resources strongly impacted student performance. The findings stressed the importance of providing adequate educational facilities, parental support, and resource allocation to improve student outcomes. In conclusion, it also emphasizes the need for policymakers and institutions to adopt strategies that enhance learning environments and support students' academic success over time.

School, family, and individual factors independently and jointly influence students' academic performance in mathematics in two Portuguese high schools. External influences such as family background and the social environment, alongside personal variables like the time students devote to learning, their aspirations, and their dedication. The results indicate that variables across all three domains have significant effects: family educational level, school support structures, and individual academic pursuit and time commitment are particularly influential (Qu, 2025). In fact, Al-Tameemi et al. (2023) conducted a systematic review of the literature to investigate the causes of low academic performance among undergraduate students. The research identified a range of factors affecting academic performance, which were further divided into personal, family, institutional, and economic domains. Students' individual factors, such as low motivation, poor time management, lack of self-discipline, and absenteeism, were among the strongest contributors to suboptimal achievement. Factors within the family, such as low parental support, limited educational background, and financial instability, were also found to be highly impactful. Ineffective teaching methods, poor learning environments, and the absence of academic support systems were among the institutional factors that made it harder for students to cope with their challenges.

Furthermore, in addition to these, socioeconomic issues such as being poor, working part-time, and not being able to afford educational materials were the most serious obstacles to academic success. The authors asserted that poor academic performance is a complex issue that will require a comprehensive approach to be overcome. They mainly emphasized the importance of student-centric teaching, effective academic mentoring, and measures to counteract economic and psychological barriers to learning as the main steps to take.

Motivation, teaching quality, and economic status are among the most significant determinants of academic performance among university students (Vergara Mendoza, 2025). Results show that there are four dominant factors that affect students' academic achievement. The complex nature of the factors that affect students' academic achievement involves internal and external factors such as academic motivation, emotional intelligence, teachers, and peers. Student-related factors had the greatest impact; teacher-related factors had the least (Vitoria et al., 2024).

In the Philippine setting, several studies echo these international trends while adding context-specific insights. For instance, B. Omaweng, (2022) at Apayao State College found that financial constraints, family obligations, and limited support mechanisms among low-income households directly affected students' grades. This highlights the role of family income and home-related factors in shaping learning outcomes. To support this, the study by LM et al., (2025) examined the factors influencing Hospitality and Tourism Management students in the Philippines when choosing a higher education institution. Using a survey-based approach, the researchers found that academic quality, affordability, institutional reputation, and social influence were the main determinants of students' choices. Among these, academic factors were the most significant, followed by financial and reputational considerations. The study also

revealed that specific demographic characteristics, such as family income and employment status, affected students' decisions, while gender and location did not. The researchers concluded that institutions should prioritize enhancing academic programs, financial support, and overall reputation to attract and retain more students.

On the contrary, family income may or may not affect students' academic performance, as shown in the study "Classification on Students' Academic Performance: A Correlational Study" by Rhino Rienz Casa, (2023) among Grade 12 students at Maguikay High School. The study found that although students mostly came from low-income backgrounds, there was "no significant correlation" between family income classification and academic achievement, indicating that students do not see poverty as a hindrance to high grades, and that being poor does not necessarily mean a student also performs poorly. The underlying causes of low academic achievement among Grade 12 students at San Ildefonso National High School in Bulacan, Philippines. Findings revealed that students' poor academic performance is influenced by three main factors: school-related issues, such as ineffective teaching methods and limited resources; home-related problems, such as a lack of parental support and financial instability; and personal factors, such as poor study habits, low motivation, and time management difficulties. The study concluded that these interconnected factors collectively hinder students' learning outcomes and recommended that schools, parents, and students work collaboratively to create supportive environments that foster better academic performance (Gutierrez Albarico et al., 2023).

Sex

The effect of gender on college students' stress and mental health can change depending on the situation, but it is still important to notice. A study by Barbayannis et al. (2022) found that students who felt more academic stress also had lower mental well-being. This shows that

schools should give extra support to students who may be more vulnerable, such as females, non-binary students, and second-year students.

Another study by Brambila-Tapia et al. (2022) found that different factors affected students' grades depending on their gender. For women, nonverbal intelligence and their previous GPA were vital. For men, emotional skills, social relationships, and personal situations like jobs or family life had a bigger impact on their grades. Moreover, CC Thelma (2023) deduced that while single-sex schools may enhance academic concentration, they often make the situation worse regarding the very nature of the existing inequality and the resulting social environment, hence the recommendation of adopting more inclusive school policies that will ensure gender equity and similar academic performance

for both sexes.

In fact, academic performance showed that both boys and girls performed well, particularly girls in the highest-scoring groups. The positive correlation between interest and participation was present for both genders, emphasizing the role of engagement in student learning. The study, however, did not establish a direct relationship among interest, participation, and academic success (Demalata et al., 2024)

Civil Status

Academic performance can be affected by whether students are married or not. Maseka et al. (2024)found that unmarried students did better when they had good interaction with their teachers compared to married students. Another study byRaza (2021) looked at married female university students and how being married affects their grades. The study found that married students often have less time to study because of household chores and family responsibilities. They may also feel pressure from expectations at home. However, married students who get

help and support from their spouse or family tend to do better in school. Iwele et al. (2023) found that many things—like family, culture, personal habits, school, and biology—can affect how well students do in school. These factors affect married and unmarried female students differently, given their different roles and responsibilities. Married women often feel stressed because of home duties, such as taking care of children, doing housework, and meeting their husband's expectations. Unmarried women may feel stressed because they are unemployed, do not get enough support, face social stigma, are mistreated by teachers, or are in uncomfortable learning environments. Both married and unmarried women face stress, but the reasons for it are different. Married women may miss classes because of home chores, while unmarried women may skip classes because of work, bullying, or social pressures. The study showed that neither group automatically does better in school; their grades mainly depend on their own effort, not on whether they are married or stressed.

Year Level

The study of D. Bautista et al. (2025) demonstrated that the year level of a student may alter the impact of stress on school performance. Various sources of stress, such as inadequacy, fear of failure, and difficulties with teachers, can either harm or help students, depending on the year they are in college. The study revealed that oldies were more or less perplexed by the instructors, depending on their year level. It suggests that stress and teacher-student interactions also have different effects on students as they progress through college. Corpuz et al. (2022) investigated Business Management students in Cavite and concluded that the most motivated students performed best academically. The factor of motivation for success was the most crucial one, followed by the necessity of cooperation and the power of influence. The research proposed that as students get older, the teachers should adopt strategies that combine

the areas of recognition, cooperation, and friendly rivalry. Moreover, Nepal & Pradhan (2022) studied various issues affecting students' grades at Amrit Campus. The researchers found out that the learner's educational level, program, and type of academic system were significant determinants of performance. For instance, graduates, semester-based students, and those in Zoology departments were found to be the best performers. On the other hand, gender was found to have a negligible influence on grades.

Family Income

Poverty has a significant impact on education. The study by Kemanae & Mnjokaya (2022) shows that parents' low income limits their ability to provide the resources necessary for students' education and academic performance in school. Furthermore, parents' income levels influence pupils' academic performance in primary schools. Various personal, family, economic, and institutional factors positively affect students' academic performance. Tharu (2024) indicates that a student's family income is one of the significant effects that influence their academic performance. Factors such as parents' income, father's education, and learning resources still play a significant role in students' academic performance, whereas other family factors appear less significant. The involvement of parents and additional support from teachers result in better student performance (Joh & William, 2024)

In fact, Khumalo and Utete (2023) reported that many factors can determine students' academic performance, including personal habits, school factors, and family income. The factors mentioned earlier—family support, access to technology, self-discipline, motivation, and time management—really contributed to excellent school performance.

A study by Mutonganirizi Chrinerius Freeman Crispus Musiimenta Nancy (2025) at Metropolitan International University found that family income affects students' grades, attendance, and

ability to buy school supplies. Students from higher-income families did better in school because their families could pay bills on time, reducing financial stress and helping them focus on their studies. Students with steady financial support were more likely to attend class regularly and participate in school activities. On the other hand, students from lower-income families sometimes missed classes or could not afford the supplies they needed. Having enough money made it easier for students to get the materials they needed, while limited income made it harder, which affected how well they could learn and perform in school.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

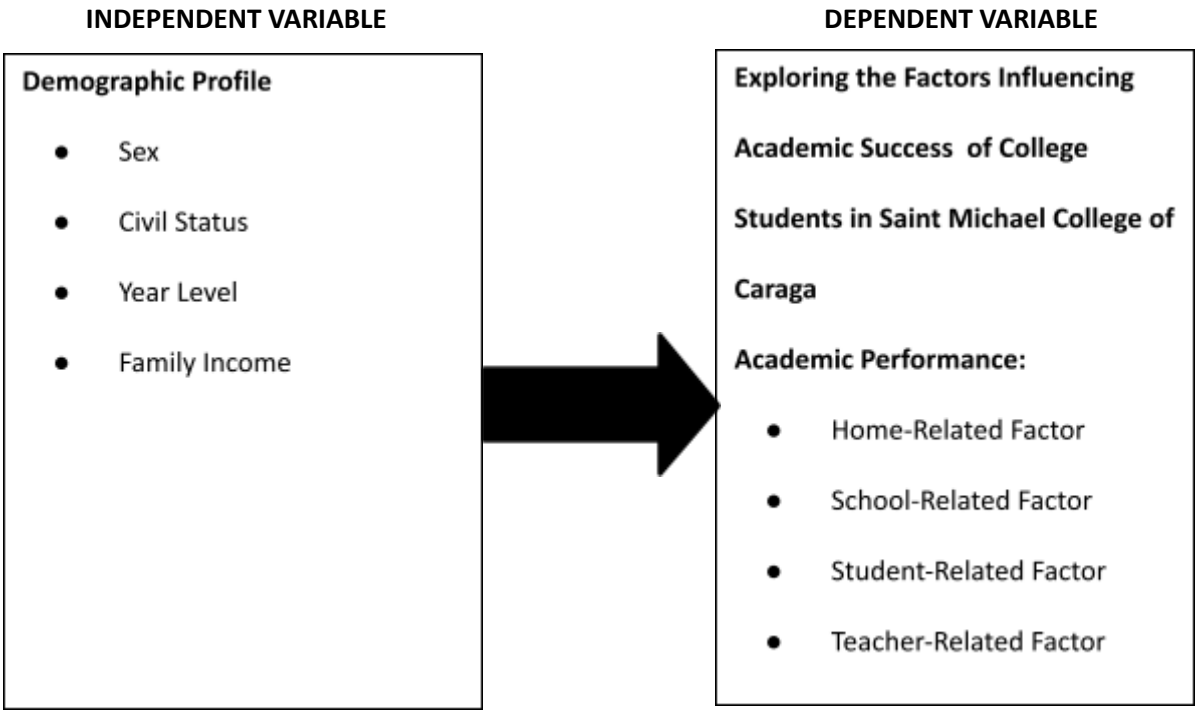


Figure 1. The schematic diagram shows the interplay between independent and dependent variables.

1.5 Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine the factors influencing the academic success of college students of Saint Michael College of Caraga, with academic performance serving as an indicator of academic success.

1. What is the profile of the respondents in terms of:
   1.1 sex;
   1.2 civil status;
   1.3 year level; and
   1.4 family income?
2. What is the level of the following factors influencing academic performance as an indicator of academic success in terms of:
   2.1 home-related factors;
   2.2 school-related factors;
   2.3 student-related factors; and
   2.4 teacher-related factors?
3. Is there a significant relationship between the identified factors (home-related, school-related, student-related, and teacher-related) and the academic performance of the respondents?
4. Is there a significant difference in the academic performance of the respondents when grouped according to their profile variables?

1.6 Hypothesis

H_0: There is no significant relationship between home-related, school-related, student-related, and teacher-related factors and the academic performance of college students of Saint Michael College of Caraga, and there is no significant difference in academic performance when students are grouped according to their profile variables (sex, civil status, year level, and family income).

1.7 Scope and Limitations

This study will focus on exploring the factors influencing academic success of college students with academic performance as an indicator, specifically considering home, school, student and teacher-related factors. The respondents of this study are the undergraduate students enrolled in the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management Department at Saint Michael College of Caraga during the academic year 2025-2026. The study is limited to gathering data through survey questionnaires which will highlight the relationship between these identified factors and students' academic performance as indicator of academic success.

In addition, the study does not cater external factors beyond the identified variables, such as government policy and technological trends that may also affect students' performance. This research is limited to a single institution; therefore, the findings may not be generalizable to other schools or universities.

1.8 Definition of Terms

For a better understanding and classification, the following terms are operationally defined as follows;

Academic Success. Refers to the achievement of desired educational outcomes by students, often reflected through measurable indicators such as academic performance.

Academic Performance. Refers to the student's academic outcome that is influenced by multiple factors.

Sex. Refers to the biological classification of the respondents as male or female.

Civil Status. Refers to respondents being single or married.

Year Level. Refers to the grade levels of the respondents of the study.

Family Income. Refers to the household income of the respondents.

Home-Related Factors. Refer to the familial and domestic conditions that affect the respondents' academic engagement.

School-Related Factors. Refers to the institutional influences of the students' academic performance.

Student-Related Factors. These refer to the personal attributes and behaviors of the respondents that influence their academic performance.

Teacher-Related Factors. Refers to the role and impact of teachers on students' academic performance.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter will outline the research design, the description of the research respondents, the instruments, the ethical standards, the data-gathering procedure, and the statistical treatment.

2.1 Research Design

A descriptive method will be employed because the researchers have sufficient prior knowledge about the research locale. This includes the survey results from all phases used to gather data. It is an organized pattern that provides for the analysis and interpretation of results on exploring the influences of academic success of CTHM students in Saint Michael College of Caraga with academic performance as an indicator.

2.2 Research Materials and Method

The study will be conducted at Saint Michael College of Caraga, Brgy. 4, Atupan St., Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, specifically in the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management. Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC) played a central role by offering Bachelor of Science in Tourism Management (BSTM), Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management (BSHM), and Ship Catering Services (SCS), preparing students for careers in these vital sectors. In Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, education in Tourism and Hospitality has evolved alongside the region's growing tourism industry.

The College of Tourism and Hospitality Management at Saint Michael College of Caraga is one of the key departments, designed to meet the growing demand for professionals in the tourism and hospitality industries, especially within the region and globally. The department aimed to develop graduates who are globally competent in the dynamic, highly competitive field of tourism and hospitality.

In presenting, analyzing and interpreting data, the researchers use the following statistical test, namely.

1. **Frequency and Percentage**- This tool will be used to answer SOP1, which presents the profile of respondents.
2. **Mean**- This tool will be used to answer SOP2 and to determine the factors influencing students' academic performance.
3. **Correlational Analysis**- It will be used to answer SOP3 and to determine the relationship between respondents' profiles and their academic performance.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

Saint Michael College of Caraga is a Roman Catholic school in Nasipit, Agusan del Norte run by the Roman Catholic Diocese of Butuan in the Philippines. Saint Michael Institute, now SMCC, was founded by the MSC fathers in 1948. The school is located at Atupan Street beside Saint Michael the Archangel Parish Church, Versoza Park, and the Municipal Hall. In 2009, the commission on higher education granted the permit to operate a Bachelor of Science in Hotel and Restaurant Management.

This study focuses and consists of all college students enrolled in the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management (CTHM) in the academic year 2025-2026, with a total of 448 students across all year levels, all of whom will be included regardless of their sex, civil status, or family income.

The study will use stratified random sampling to ensure that all year levels are proportionally represented in the sample, and each respondent will be randomly selected from each group.

Table 1. Respondents of the study

All year level Program	POPULATION Male F	Female F	Total	SAMPLE Male f	Female f	Total F	Percentage %
BSHM	92	108	200	46.2	54.241	100	44.6
BSTM	17	138	155	8.54	69.308	77.8	34.6
SCS	85	8	93	42.7	4.0179	46.7	20.8
Total	**194**	**254**	**448**	**97.4**	**127.57**	**225**	**100**

Table 1 shows the distribution of respondents involved in the study. Specifically, Bachelor of Science in Tourism Management, Bachelor of Science in Hospitality Management and Ships Catering Services students in Saint Michael College of Caraga.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

The research instrument that this study will use is a modified adaptive survey questionnaire from the study of Olamit et al., titled "*Factors Affecting Academic Performance of Hospitality Students*" that has a total of 40 items. The research instrument will be divided into five parts. Part I will focus on establishing the demographic profile of the respondents and on gathering information on sex, civil status, year level, and family income. Part II, III, IV and V will be focused on the distribution of factors influencing academic performance such as home, school, student, and teacher-related factors.

Data Gathering Procedure

In gathering the data, the researchers sent a request letter to the school registrar, which was verified by the CTHM dean, to obtain the complete list of respondents for the study. This list was then forwarded to the statistician to ensure that the population remained consistent. After confirming this, the researchers adapted the research instrument. Subsequently, the researchers sent an approval letter to the CTHM dean to seek permission to conduct the study. After

securing approval, the researchers will conduct the actual data gathering and distribute the survey questionnaire to obtain the results. Once all data has been collected, the researchers will tally all the results based on the questionnaires answered by the respondents. They submitted the tabulated data to the statistician to ensure accuracy and reliability. After obtaining the tabulated data from the statistician, the researchers will analyze, interpret, and discuss the gathered information.

Respondents will rate each statement using a four-point Likert Scale:

5– Strongly Agree, 4 – Agree, 3-Neutral, 2 – Disagree, and 1 –Strongly Disagree.

Table 2. Respondents' Demographic Profile

Variable	Indicators
Sex	☐ Male ☐ Female
Civil Status	☐ Single ☐ Married ☐ Separated
Year Level	☐ 1st Year ☐ 2nd Year ☐ 3rd Year ☐ 4th Year
Family Income (Monthly)	☐ Below ₱10,000 ☐ ₱10,001–₱20,000 ☐ ₱20,001–₱30,000 ☐ ₱30,001–Above 40,000

Table 3.Home-Related Factor

Items	(SA) 5	(A) 4	(N) 3	(D) 2	(SD) 1
1. My parents motivate me to improve my academic performance. 2. I use appropriate learning materials (books, dictionaries, laptop) for my studies. 3. I attend tutorial sessions or extra lessons after class when necessary. 4. My parents provide support and guidance with my academic tasks when needed. 5. I seek guidance from my family or elders regarding my studies. 6. I can focus on my studies despite distractions from friends. 7. I am able to manage household chores without it negatively affecting my studies. 8. I am able to study effectively even if my siblings cause disturbances. 9. I can study without being distracted by mobile phones, television, radio, or other gadgets. 10. My family's financial situation does not prevent me from focusing on my studies.					
Mean					

Table 4. School-Related Factor

Items	(SA) 5	(A) 4	(N) 3	(D) 2	(SD) 1
1. I make full use of the learning facilities provided by the school (library, and computer lab) 2. I effectively use the school's learning facilities to complete coursework. 3. I believe the school facilities meet the necessary standards for classrooms, lighting, air conditioning, tables, and chairs. 4. I can easily access the internet in the school when needed. 5. I follow the school's "Speak English Policy" during academic activities. 6. My parents support the school's instructional or educational philosophy. 7. The school promotes high academic achievement among students. 8. The school provides information to parents regarding students' academic performance relative to their peers. 9. The school adequately coordinates with external examination boards. 10. The school complies with regulations from regional or national educational authorities.					
Mean					

Table 5. Student-Related Factor

Items	(SA) 5	(A) 4	(N) 3	(D) 2	(SD) 1
1. I listen attentively to my teacher during class. 2. I actively participate in class discussions and clarify points I do not understand. 3. I am motivated to achieve good grades on tests, quizzes, assignments, and projects. 4. I prepare myself adequately for each subject. 5. I manage my frustration when class discussions are interrupted or the teacher is absent. 6. I exert extra effort when completing difficult assignments. 7. I study lessons I missed whenever I am absent from class. 8. I consistently study and prepare for quizzes and exams. 9. I ensure that extracurricular activities do not interfere with my studies. 10. I have a designated study space at home that is clean and organized.					
Mean					

Table 6. Teacher-Related Factor

Items	(SA) 5	(A) 4	(N) 3	(D) 2	(SD) 1
1. My teachers maintain good relationships with students and fellow teachers. 2. My teachers enforce proper discipline and follow the rules consistently. 3. My teachers are open to suggestions and value students' opinions. 4. My teachers demonstrate confidence and firmness in decision-making. 5. My teachers have an appealing personality and a good sense of humor. 6. My teachers clearly explain the objectives of each lesson at the beginning of class. 7. My teachers have mastery over the subject matter. 8. My teachers organize their lessons systematically according to the course schedule. 9. My teachers stay updated on current trends relevant to their subjects. 10. My teachers use a variety of teaching strategies, aids, and techniques to facilitate learning.					
Mean					

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Right

The information that will be gathered from respondents will be kept highly confidential and well-protected to avoid misconceptions about this research. The respondents will be given code names to hide their personal information and secure their identity. This study adheres to the Data Privacy Act of the Philippines, and the data collected will be used solely for this research.

B. Informed Consent

The respondents will be the CTHM department across all year levels from Saint Michael College of Caraga. The respondents undergo a brief orientation conducted by the researchers to better understand the study's purpose and the potential benefits and risks before agreeing to participate. The respondents will be informed of their right to withdraw from the study at any time without any explanation. During the orientation, a written consent form will be distributed to each respondent to ensure they fully understand their rights.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

The respondents will be the CTHM department across all year levels from Saint Michael College of Caraga. The respondents undergo a brief orientation conducted by the researchers to better understand the study's purpose and the potential benefits and risks before agreeing to participate. The respondents will be informed of their right to withdraw from the study at any time without any explanation. During the orientation, a written consent form will be distributed to each respondent to ensure they fully understand their rights.

D. Voluntary participation

Participation in the study will be voluntary. Respondents in the study will be informed of their right to withdraw without any negative consequences. No animals will be involved in this study; therefore, the consideration of alternatives to animal use will not be applicable.

E. Minimization of Harm

The researchers will engage with the respondents respectfully and professionally to establish a safe and supportive environment throughout the study. If any risks are identified, respondents are referred to appropriate support services to ensure their well-being, such as the clinic and the Guidance Office, for assistance as needed during the research process. After participation, researchers will provide a debriefing session to ensure no physical, psychological, or emotional harm occurs throughout the research process. The study will not involve animal subjects; the 3Rs principles of replacement, reduction, and refinement do not apply.

F. Beneficence

This study will contribute to a better understanding of the challenges faced by CTHM students and their level of preparedness for upcoming internships. The study's findings will be available upon request from the respondents. The study's benefits will focus on improving the program and will be based on its results.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Respondents will be selected using well-defined, fair inclusion criteria to ensure the selection process aligns with the study's objectives. Respondents from diverse backgrounds will be included fairly without discrimination.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Data collection and analysis will be conducted using standardized methods to ensure accurate and reliable results. Initially, the researchers submitted a formal request to the school registrar to obtain the complete list of eligible respondents for the study. All findings will undergo a careful review to avoid potential bias or error, and no limitations will be identified in the study.

I. Transparency in Reporting

The study's findings will be reported honestly, with no manipulation or alteration of the data. All sources, including academic references, will be cited appropriately and acknowledged to respect intellectual property rights and uphold ethical research standards. This study utilizes some AI tools to support various aspects of the research. There will be no potential conflict of interest involved in the study.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

No patented materials should be involved in this study. All copyrighted materials, including references, will be cited appropriately in accordance with intellectual property laws. The researchers will ensure that all sources are appropriately acknowledged, maintaining academic integrity and avoiding plagiarism.

K. Considerations for Human Subjects

The researchers will inform the respondents about the possible risks and potential benefits of the study, ensuring that an informed consent form is provided. If any significant risks are associated, such as emotional, physical, or psychological risks, appropriate health monitoring programs and emotional support services are available.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related technology

The researchers use digital technologies throughout the research process, including finding reliable articles to maintain the study's accuracy and credibility. AI tools, such as ChatGPT, will be utilized to assist in summarizing statements and enhancing the quality of the study. Platforms like Google Scholar and Elicit are used to find supporting studies, ensuring the reliability and credibility of the research. Additionally, Grammarly is used to ensure that the research report adheres to proper grammar and clarity standards. The responsible use of technologies helped maintain the integrity of the study.

M. Ethical Approval

The research obtained ethical approval from the Institutional Review Board of Saint Michael College of Caraga, confirming its compliance with all relevant guidelines on the protection of respondents, data privacy, and intellectual property rights.